Echo Chambers, Systemic Distrust, and Misinformation: A Critical Examination of Black Twitter as a Digital Counterpublic

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Abstract

This paper reconceptualizes Black Twitter as an epistemically virtuous echo chamber and digital counterpublic. While echo chambers are often seen as isolating and harmful, Black Twitter fosters critical engagement, collective verification, and the amplification of marginalized voices. Examining COVID-19 misinformation, the paper shows how systemic distrust—rooted in historical and ongoing racial injustices—shapes epistemic practices. Rather than blaming individuals, it advocates restorative epistemic justice through trust-building, culturally relevant communication, and structural reform, addressing misinformation while empowering marginalized communities and recognizing the structural roots of epistemic challenges.

1. INTRODUCTION

In an increasingly digital world, conversations about echo chambers have become more salient, especially as social media shapes how people form beliefs and decide whom to trust. Echo chambers are epistemic structures that actively discredit outside voices, creating a sharp disparity in trust between members and non-members (Nguyen 146). This dynamic is created through the systematic exclusion and pre-emptive discrediting of outsiders, which isolates members from external epistemic sources and helps explain the spread of misinformation and resistance to clear evidence. Nguyen argues that these mechanisms resemble cult indoctrination because they manipulate trust and credentially isolate members (Nguyen 147).

Although this critique initially seems persuasive, it is incomplete. It focuses primarily on right wing and white male dominated examples such as Derek Black's former neo-Nazi community or the Pizzagate conspiracy, and it does not account for echo chamber like spaces within marginalized communities. Black Twitter makes these limitations especially clear.

In this paper, I argue that echo chambers are not inherently epistemically problematic. Black Twitter, often described as an echo chamber, also functions as a digital counterpublic that

allows marginalized users to build trust, challenge dominant narratives, and practice epistemic virtues. At the same time, structural distrust shaped by historical inequities can contribute to the spread of misinformation. This tension was especially visible during COVID 19 when community driven narratives on Black Twitter coexisted with high rates of infection, death, and vaccine hesitancy in Black communities. This paper will expand on Nguyen's work by focusing on echo chambers within Black Twitter through four key points, I will explore (1) the epistemic structures of Black Twitter as a counterpublic, (2) the epistemic virtues that exist within this echo chamber, (3) the role of systemic harms in spreading misinformation, and (4) the ethical implications of assigning blame to individuals within these contexts, concluding with comparable remedies for addressing such dynamics[1].

2. BLACK TWITTER

Rather than an official platform, Black Twitter is a subculture on Twitter where Black users share and discuss topics relevant to their communities. This is not limited to Black consumers of media, but also producers what I will refer to as "Black Press". Interestingly Black Twitter is not a necessarily enclosed digital space the movement of users in and out of this subset make membership both fluid and static. However, Black Twitter is an echo chamber. It exists with Black people who consider each other like-minded, through selective exposure that happens unavoidably on social media (Nguyen 145). Within this chamber, there is an amplification of internal voices that are insulated from opposing views and direct access to this testimony allows members to establish trust. Prevailing topics of interest within Black Twitter such as anti-Black state violence or racial injustice reinforce the original belief of mistrust (Nguyen 146). While existing on a digital plain, these issues are common even in Black communities, reaffirming that echo chambers are natural perversions and useful for institutional and individual trust.

[1] Note: At this time "Twitter" has been renamed as "X"

Nguyen highlights the mechanisms and implications of echo chambers and distinguishes them from epistemic bubbles. According to Nguyen, an epistemic bubble is a social structure in which relevant voices or viewpoints have been left out, often unintentionally, through mechanisms like selective exposure or algorithmic filtering (Nguyen 143). Members of epistemic bubbles lack access to contrary perspectives but are not conditioned to distrust those outside their networks. Thus, these structures are relatively easy to escape, where mere exposure to excluded evidence or arguments can expand one's epistemic horizons (Nguyen 145).

By contrast, echo chambers are far more robust and harmful. They actively manipulate trust to exclude and discredit outsiders systematically (Nguyen 146). Echo chamber members are conditioned to distrust external sources, often through deliberate mechanisms that isolate them epistemically. These practices reinforce the credibility of in-group sources while undermining the credibility of outsiders, creating a self-reinforcing cycle that is difficult to escape. Echo chambers also employ mechanisms like disagreement reinforcement as a protective mechanism, where contrary evidence is interpreted as further proof of outsider maliciousness, thereby strengthening the original beliefs (Nguyen 147).

Nguyen stresses that escaping an echo chamber is not as simple as encountering opposing evidence (Nguyen 155). He argues for a social epistemic reboot — a radical process in which individuals temporarily suspend all prior beliefs and rebuild their epistemic framework with equal openness to diverse sources of testimony (Nguyen 157). Importantly, Nguyen addresses the question of epistemic responsibility, distinguishing between individuals who willingly enter echo chambers and those born into them. The latter, he argues, may not be blameworthy, as they often operate with epistemic virtues corrupted by their social contexts (Nguyen 155).

While Nguyen captures the mechanisms of epistemic entrapment within echo chambers, his analysis overlooks the diversity of echo chamber content-structures and how they can manifest differently across identities and communities. His recommendation for cultivating

trust between members and outsiders is valuable but may be overly simplistic given the complexity of echo chambers rooted in marginalized identities.

Black Twitter is a virtual community of Twitter users who are engaged in real-time discourse primarily related to Black American culture and politics (Hill 287)[2]. "Counterpublic" refers to Nancy Frasers (1920) "subaltern counterpublic" conception where private citizens come together to publicly discuss ideas, resolve problems, and confront State power (Hill 288). Black Twitter functions as a digital counterpublic, where Black communities disseminate information unreported within traditional mainstream media outlets. The speakerphone platform is a tool, means, and medium to call for new evidence and demand accountability for harm against Black people. This is a digital space that engages in broader dialogues surrounding blackness (Hill 287).

For instance, Black Twitter has been responsible for calling attention to racial injustices such as the murders of Black bodies including Micheal Brown – an unarmed Black male who Police Officer Darren Wilson murdered in Ferguson, Missouri (Hill 286). Black Twitter in conjunction with community leaders demanded the release of the officer's name and organized protests against the Ferguson Police Department. Black Twitter offers a platform where Black voices and lived experiences shape discourse, resist oppression, and challenge dominant narratives (Hill 287). This counterpublic reveals its role in fostering collective resistance, particularly against state violence, through hashtags and digital activism.

While it may prima facie appear as a problem with social media users and their exposure to engaging with misinformation, I offer the findings of Giovanini, et al. (2023) whose study argues that people still care about facts and that Twitter users might engage more with factual discourse than misinformation to counter such an assumption. Within the parameters of this paper, I will attempt to summarize the study findings. The study analyzes Twitter engagement

[2] While Black Twitters primary discourse is in relation to Black American culture, conversations around Blackness in general pervade the discourse. The focus on Black American culture is for the purpose of the argument. Due to the prevalence of Black American cultures' influence transnationally, membership of users is also diversified. My own fascination with Black Twitter began while in Zambia.

with 2.1 million tweets, focusing on COVID-19 and general topics.

The study highlights four key aspects of online engagement. First, factual engagement shows that factual tweets generate significantly higher interaction than misinformation across both COVID-19 and general topics, with COVID-related factual posts strongly correlated with sentiment, emotion, and writing confidence (Giovanini et al. 14). Second, misinformation patterns reveal that engagement with misinformation varies: COVID-related misinformation aligns with grammar and informal speech, while general-topic misinformation is tied to user metadata such as follower count and verification status (Giovanini et al. 15). Third, engagement features indicate that clear language and emotional appeal drive interaction with factual COVID content, whereas informal syntax and user profile attributes shape engagement with general misinformation (Giovanini et al. 16). Finally, the implications show that countering misinformation effectively requires tailored, issue-specific strategies rather than broad, generalized interventions (Giovanini et al. 17–18).

Instead of the natural assumption that Twitter creates echo chambers and that these are responsible for the spread of misinformation, the above study offers a different perspective in viewing this specific social media landscape. Although the study would fail to capture the nature of tweets within "Black Twitter," it does give an alternative, not a definitive avenue to view it. I will use a more recent study by Allissa Richardson and Miya Williams Fayne (2025) on how Black Press as media outlets interacted with consumers within this chamber and how they responded to specifically racialized misinformation.

This study found that Black Press dispelled racialized coronavirus misinformation by referring to celebrities, social changes, safety guidelines and by practicing public interest journalism (Richardson & Fayne 1427)[3]. By covering elite Black people's covid related cases

[3] Black Press includes 50 Black digital publications including: *The Shade Room, Essence magazine, VIBE, Love B Scott, Black Doctor, Bossip, Madam Noire and News One, The undefeated, Black Sports*

they dispelled myths around immunity within Black communities. Or similarly getting well known actress Tiffany Haddish in a live call with Dr Anthony Faucci for a Q&A session – which many Black press outlets reshared and referenced in reporting. This helped with the communication by seeing the layman interact with the expert live to receive accurate information about the virus. Moreover, including testimony from celebrity families on how the virus infected their families allowed for an empathetic view of its effects (Richardson & Fayn 1428).

Additionally, media outlets editors engaged with and removed social media comments that would encourage the spread of misinformation. The restrictive approach of comments allowed for the editors to review commentary and reposition different editions to reply with popular trends of problematic content. This allowed for readers to be focused on correct content that was posted by the outlets. To further counter racialized misinformation editors posted specifically how the pandemic affected Black Americans for example, Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCU's), and Essence magazine partnered the American Medical Association to distribute resources and information to Black communities (Richardson & Fayn 1429).

Driving their counter narrative approach Black press utilized public interest journalism by offering Q&A sessions to provide the public directly with facts and free resources. Black users could directly interact with Black health care professionals. Seeing people who looked like them sharing information in culturally relevant ways allowed for trust to built. They provided people with aid, relief and access to resources for economic security (Richardson & Fayn 1430)

The approach taken by relevant Black Press makes it plausible that engagement with factual tweets increases when they are clear, emotionally resonant, and culturally relevant. Both studies by Giovanni et al and Richardson & Fayne give grounds that factual tweets are

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Online, The Grio etc. For more review Richardson and Fayne(2025).

significantly more engaging than misinformation tweets across both COVID-19 and general topics. These dynamics highlight how Black Twitter could leverage epistemic tools to validate community-specific knowledge, even when mainstream institutions do not meet the community's needs. Far from being merely insular, Black Twitter's discourse can reflect active resistance to systemic erasure and delegitimization of Black epistemic agency.

3. EPISTEMIC VIRTUE IN BLACK TWITTER AS AN ECHO CHAMBER

Nguyen emphasizes that echo chambers function by actively discrediting outsiders while reinforcing trust in internal voices (Nguyen 146). In Black Twitter, this mechanism is not a failing but an adaptive response to systemic distrust. Jeniffer Lackey (2021) argues that echo chambers are not by themselves epistemically problematic, and that we ought to look at content-driven and not structural explanation of what if anything is "wrong" (Lackey 225). Following Lackeys argument, a misconception about such an echo chamber is that; where there is internal amplification of Black voices there is no process of discrediting. However, the Black Twitter community explicitly critiques articulations of respectability politics of internal voices, which refers to attempts by marginalized groups to gain acceptance by conforming to the dominant culture's norms and values, often at the expense of addressing systemic inequalities (Hill 296).

For instance, the Black Twitter community critiqued NBA player Damian Lillard for invoking respectability politics in response to the 2016 police killings of Alton Sterling and Philando Castile. Lillard blamed Black community "behavior", instead of systemic issues such as over policing in black communities and higher rates of brutality in arresting black people (Hill 294). Users rejected his framing as unethical, ahistorical, and irrelevant, emphasizing structural determinants of violence. Following the backlash, Lillard expressed remorse and openness to learning (Hill 295). Regardless of his response, the incident became a critical pedagogical moment for Black Twitter to reject respectability politics and educate broader audiences. Black Twitter does not exhibit the prototypical epistemically problematic behavior

of discrediting the testimony of any outside voice, and elevating the credibility of any internal voices, simply because they are internal; instead testimony of individuals who belong to the community are held to epistemic standards and are criticized for making certain mistakes(mistakes that one would be much more likely to get away with in other digital spaces).

Moreover, a movement that arose from Black Twitter called "#SayHerName," became a space for the community to engage in intersectional feminist politics that resists the erasure of Black femmes from conversations about anti-Black state violence (Hill 296). This was a conversation that was created as a recognition of the lack of comparable media attention given to Black feminine identifying peoples during the same time of the murder of Micheal Brown. Furthermore, this hashtag gave way to information and dialogue about more injustices against Black femmes. Even this action radically shifted how state violence is imagined and contested within Black Twitter (Hill, 296). Black Twitter does not operate as a space where people passively accept information.

The functions within Black Twitter are exercised with epistemic virtues such as open-mindedness, epistemic humility, epistemic courage and hermeneutical heroism,.[4] Open-mindedness refers to a reflexive element that involves being alert, attentive and responsive to different ways and styles of communication that treats personal accounts not merely as data to be analyzed but also recognized; Black Twitter has shown example of this (Gosselin 56). Epistemic humility involves an awareness of one's own epistemic capacities and limitations, again a virtue this chamber demonstrates where you have consumers looking to advance their own understandings by attending sessions such as the Q&A's on COVID-19 and further, Black press acknowledging their own limitations and then outsourcing education directly from healthcare experts such as Dr Faucci. This has allowed for discourse to facilitate the pursuit of knowledge by taking alternative ideas as serious before responding.

[4] For the definitions for the use of open-mindedness, epistemic humility, epistemic courage and hermeneutical heroism as virtues see Abigail Gosselin (2019)

Additionally, members within Black Twitter display epistemic courage that involves pursuing epistemic goods despite the risks involved, including potential harm to oneself. When people share their lived stories, they also run the risk of being dismissed and overlooked all of which take courage, this is perhaps the most important one as members of these communities especially being black run risk from various forms of oppression. This courage becomes necessary to influence structural change, pointing to why this space is ever fluid — different acts of courageous within this chamber allow for structural changes around what is disseminated and shared internally. Hermeneutical heroism is a form of epistemic generosity and especially relevant in the case of Black twitter whereby black people who are often devalued and unjustly excluded from participating in interpretation, knowledge making where dominant (white and male) perspectives are imposed on lived experiences. This is virtuous when the marginalized person shares epistemic resources and capabilities with those that are privileged; so that they can expand their own capabilities. For any Black speaker or scholar attempting to do this takes cognitive and emotional labor especially when engaging with counternarratives that dismiss these experiences. Black Twitter displays acts of hermeneutical heroism especially when we put the event of COVID into perspective of 2019-2020 where black people were driving the Black Lives Matter protests after the circulation of the murdering of George Floyd. While this sort of heroism might not be explicitly an epistemic virtue it is an ideal that might be necessary to cultivate for the process of trust to begin with.

With the examples of how Black Press functions internally within Black Twitter, the internal critic of members like Lillard and complimentary intersectional campaigns like #Sayhername display these epistemically virtuous practices. Additionally, the engagement study by Giovanini, et al. highlights how structural inequities, such as unequal access to verification tools and platform prominence, shape the spread of misinformation and not necessarily vicious attitudes.

4. CASE STUDY: COVID-19 MISINFORMATION AND SYSTEMIC DISTRUST

Now that I have explored an alternative perspective on understanding interactions within Black Twitter as an echo chamber, the question becomes: if agents within Black Twitter have robust systems for verifying, sharing, and assessing information, why did Black communities experience higher rates of COVID-19 infections and deaths, along with notable levels of "vaccine hesitancy"? (Jaiswal, J et al.)[5].

The circulation of COVID-19 misinformation on Black Twitter offers a reflection on the broader context of systemic distrust in health care and public institutions. As Wilson (2022) argues, vaccine hesitancy in Black communities stems not from ignorance but from rational responses to historical abuses like the Tuskegee Syphilis Study and ongoing racial disparities in medical treatment. This offers a more nuanced understanding of the mistrust that is an essential element of Nguyen's understanding of echo chambers, where mistrust is justified as an internal epistemic practice while isolating members from external voices.

Because of the conditions that Black people face, asking why they are "hesitant" about vaccines often reinforces racist assumptions about their intelligence, reasoning, and decision-making (Wilson 13). Similarly, I will highlight the rational appeal to distrust by Black People in healthcare with examples of historic injustice. I will offer a "historic" example and a more contemporary example of justification for this.

Firstly, the reference to J. Marion Sims gynecologic experiments in the 1840s on Black enslaved women — White audiences were invited to gawk at their vaginas, and Black women in the American South were subjected to forced sterilizations without anesthesia. (Wilson 14). Secondly, while there are several examples I could provide from the 1840s till today, I offer this contemporary one from December 2020 during COVID-19 (Wilson 14). This example refers to the case of Susan Moore, who was a family physician. After Moore contracted COVID-19 and was hospitalized and shared videos on Twitter, she reported that hospital staff ignored

[5] See Jaiswal J et a(2020) for more on how Black communities have been blamed for higher fatality rates among Black populations.

her accounts of pain. Moore shared that instead of care in the hospital, Moore was treated like "an addict asking for a fix" when requesting medication and was ignored by other physicians in the hospital. In a video circulated on Black Twitter, millions of Black people saw Moore with a staggered breath and uttered, "This is how Black People get killed" — she died sixteen days after posting this clip (Wilson 14).

The epistemic practices of sharing stories/information within a Black Twitter context look different from traditional Western colonial academic contexts such as academic reviewing. The injustice is shared, and the central question concerns those who are most affected by it. With this type of sharing, there is instead a form of collective grief in the Black experience rather than individual opinion. Due to the type of interactions that exist within the sphere of Black Twitter, these historic injustices have been revealed, and they now form the foundation of critical analysis of black people in healthcare. Instead, the history that exists in these stories activates lingering generational trauma that injustice weighs on Black people and on their actions too (Wilson 14). An echo chamber like Black Twitter helps to communicate the kinds of facts that provide a basis for rational vaccine hesitancy within certain Black communities.

Moore's story becomes one of many defining experiences that reflect racial disparities in health care. However, traditional media did not cover these stories and did not give them the credence that Black Twitter did. So, when you have large numbers of Black People who refuse or hesitate to receive vaccines are we to say that this is irrational? To claim this understanding would be dismissive and ignorant with a specific form of epistemic injustice that is gaslighting where the hearer of testimony raises doubts on a speaker's credibility in perceiving events accurately, as Rachel McKinnon (2017) describes it. It is particularly rational when we consider historical injustice that exists presently with its connection to epistemic injustices. Black Twitter amplifies Black stories serving as a trusted space for community-specific health discourse.

However, the misinformation study demonstrates that environments shaped by systemic distrust create the conditions in which misinformation can circulate more readily. Distrust does

not simply predispose individuals to reject authoritative sources; it also produces epistemic gaps that factual narratives often fail to fill, especially when those narratives do not address the specific cultural, historical, and material concerns of marginalized communities. When institutional communication does not speak to lived experience, members of those communities may turn to alternative epistemic networks—such as Black Twitter—to make sense of ongoing harms and uncertainties. In this context, misinformation thrives not because of epistemic irresponsibility but because structural inequities have eroded trust in mainstream institutions while failing to provide credible, culturally responsive information. Understanding misinformation on Black Twitter therefore requires recognizing it not as an epistemic failing of individuals but as a predictable outcome of long-standing institutional neglect, racialized health inequities, and the absence of trustworthy, community-centered communication.

5. THE ETHICAL IMPLICATIONS OF BLAME

Blaming, i.e., judging that the relevant individuals have done something morally or epistemically problematic — within Black Twitter for spreading misinformation ignores the structural factors that shape their epistemic environment. Nguyen emphasizes that members of echo chambers are often exhibiting epistemic virtue, following principles of trust and credence that have been distorted by external forces. However, arguing that actively entering an echo chamber is blameworthy as they "abandon" a wide range of resources entering a chamber (Nguyen 154). In contrast, Wilson's paper counters this, showing how systemic failures in healthcare have made distrust a rational and sometimes necessary stance for marginalized communities. Making the motivation for black people to join Black Twitter as plausibly blameless.

The engagement of the Twitter study also reveals that misinformation's spread could be heavily influenced by systemic factors, such as prominence of the verified users and algorithmic amplification, rather than individual epistemic practices within such an echo chamber. Blaming individuals in such a case reinforces a carceral logic that looks to punish marginalized groups

for navigating systems that have already been designed to exclude and disenfranchise them. If we blame agents and judge that Black Twitter members who spread misinformation have violated an epistemic obligation we would in turn be reinforcing this logic as a form of social control that punishes or confines people socially, legally, or psychologically. When blame is pervasive or overly punitive, it can resemble a carceral approach to social issues, emphasizing restriction and punishment rather than understanding, forgiveness, or restoration. Nguyen argues that dismantling echo chambers requires addressing the structures of distrust, not merely exposing members to neutral facts. Blaming in the sense of public, collective action works against this goal by reinforcing a carceral approach.

A crucial distinction must be made between the epistemic obligations of Black Twitter members and the question of whether public criticism should target them. Circulating medical misinformation may, at first glance, appear to violate epistemic duties such as sharing accurate information and critically evaluating sources. However, within the context of Black Twitter, these actions are often shaped by systemic distrust of healthcare institutions, historical medical injustices, and unequal access to culturally relevant guidance. Additionally, the sharing of such tweets may also be to encourage dissent in these chambers and to open conversations of dissemination. In this sense, any epistemic "misstep" is inseparable from the broader social and structural conditions in which members operate. Separately, even if individual obligations are arguably unmet, public criticism or shaming is likely counterproductive. As Nguyen and Wilson emphasize, punitive approaches reinforce distrust and reproduce a carceral logic, whereas restorative interventions—such as culturally resonant communication, collaboration with trusted community figures, and efforts to build institutional trust—address the root causes of misinformation without unjustly targeting individuals. Distinguishing these two points clarifies that assessing epistemic responsibility and determining the ethics of public accountability require distinct, context-sensitive considerations.

To assign blame in the present case would be to perpetuate epistemic injustice. Epistemic injustice would be discrimination against moral agents unfairly discriminated against in their capacity as a knower. In Ben Almassi's (2018) work on epistemic injustice and its amelioration, he advocates for restorative epistemic justice as a relational and reparative framework (Almassi 96). This approach prioritizes acknowledging epistemic wrongs, making amends tailored to the needs of those harmed, and fostering collaboration to restore or create morally adequate relationships. Almassi draws significantly from Marget Walker's concept of moral repair, emphasizing the need to rebuild trust and reaffirm the social standing of those marginalized or harmed by epistemic injustices (Almassi 96).

This section argues that blame is not an appropriate response to the circulation of misinformation within Black Twitter because assigning blame risks compounding existing epistemic injustices. Restorative epistemic justice is particularly relevant in non-ideal contexts where systemic inequalities already undermine trust, credibility, and epistemic agency, as seen in the patterns of misinformation discussed earlier. Almassi emphasizes that such injustices degrade the self-trust and epistemic authority of individuals or groups (Almassi 98). Importantly, restorative epistemic justice is not about excusing the spread of misinformation; the problem itself remains significant. Rather, it seeks to address both the residual harms of past and ongoing injustices and the structural conditions that allow misinformation to proliferate, creating pathways for meaningful remediation (Almassi 102). In this framework, interventions should focus on repairing trust, improving access to accurate and culturally relevant information, and empowering marginalized communities to exercise epistemic agency, rather than centering blame on individual actors. This approach acknowledges the problem of misinformation while reframing the response in a justice-oriented, constructive manner.

Restorative epistemic justice involves a multi-step process aimed at repairing the harms caused by epistemic injustice. First, it requires an acknowledgment of the injustice, recognizing that epistemic harm has occurred and working to restore the victim's diminished standing within

the epistemic community. Second, it involves taking concrete amends and reparative actions that address both relational and structural harms, guided by the priorities and needs of those affected. Finally, it emphasizes the renewal of collaboration and trust, fostering conditions in which epistemic agency can be restored and allowing both victims and those responsible for harm to participate equitably in the epistemic community. Together, these steps provide a constructive framework for addressing misinformation while promoting justice, trust, and accountability within epistemic networks.

Building on the epistemic virtues observed within Black Twitter—such as critical engagement, collective verification, and the rigorous evaluation of internal testimony—it becomes clear that addressing misinformation cannot rely on blaming individual users. Instead, restorative epistemic justice provides a framework for responding to misinformation in a way that acknowledges both the structural roots of distrust, and the epistemic agency exercised within the community. This approach shifts attention from punitive measures to relational and systemic repair, beginning with the acknowledgment of historical and ongoing exclusion of Black voices from public discourse and the devaluation of lived experience as credible knowledge. It then moves to concrete amends, such as collaborative campaigns with trusted Black Twitter influencers, transparent institutional accountability, and the creation of mechanisms for communities to actively verify and share accurate information. Finally, it emphasizes the deliberate cultivation of trust through sustained engagement, structural reform, and amplification of marginalized voices, ensuring that Black communities can meaningfully influence decision-making processes. By integrating restorative epistemic practices with the existing epistemic strengths of Black Twitter, misinformation is addressed not as an individual failing but as a symptom of systemic inequities, fostering an inclusive, equitable, and resilient epistemic landscape that empowers the community while repairing historical harms.

6. Conclusion

This paper has shown that Black Twitter operates as a digital counterpublic and an epistemically virtuous echo chamber, fostering trust and community narratives that challenge systemic racial injustice. While Nguyen's framework explains how echo chambers function, it does not account for the historical and structural forces that shape mistrust in marginalized communities. The example of COVID-19 misinformation demonstrates how systemic neglect deepens collective distrust, and blaming individuals in such contexts reinforces carceral logic rather than addressing the roots of mistrust. A restorative approach that begins building trust, acknowledges historical harms, and amplifies culturally grounded information offers a more just and effective response. Recognizing Black Twitter's epistemic virtues and critical role in shaping collective knowledge opens possibilities for addressing misinformation while empowering marginalized voices and strengthening a more equitable epistemic landscape.

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